5E LESSON PLAN: WEEK 10 – MISS PATTERSON

- **Institution:** Happy Grove High School
- **Grade Level:** Grade 8
- **Class:** 8^3
- **Subject:** English Literature
- **Date:** November 16, 2026
- **Duration:** 60 minutes
- **NSC Learning Strand:** Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature); Communication (Writing) – plot structure
- **NSC Attainment Target:** Identify and comment on the structural organization of narrative texts; track how plot components build tension, reach a climax and lead to a resolution.
- **Topic:** Plot Structure – The Complete Plot of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson (Exposition to Resolution) and Writing a PEE Paragraph
- **Previous Knowledge:** In Weeks 2–6, students studied setting, characterization and Man vs. Man conflict in Chapters 1–6 of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson. In Week 8 they learned ballads and free verse, and in Week 9 imagery and theme in "My Parents", writing a paragraph that compares Rami and the speaker.

Key Vocabulary

Key Vocabulary (word wall)

Freytag's Pyramid: a diagram shaped like a pyramid that shows the five stages of a plot

Exposition: the beginning, where the characters, setting and problem are introduced

Rising action: the events and complications that build tension toward the climax

Climax: the turning point; the moment of greatest tension

Falling action: the events just after the climax, as things begin to settle

Resolution: the ending, where the conflict is settled

Conflict: the struggle or problem in a story (man vs. man, man vs. society, man vs. self)

PEE paragraph: a paragraph that makes a Point, gives Evidence from the text and Explains how the evidence proves the point

Discuss (command word): give a full answer that looks at the topic closely, using examples from the text

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson:

Cognitive

1. After the Explain phase, students will define the five stages of plot, with at least four of the five correct.
2. Using the event strips, students will classify at least nine of the eleven main events of the novel under the correct plot stage.

Affective

3. During the group sort, students will carry out their role-slip task, contributing at least one reason for where an event belongs.

Psychomotor

4. Using the PEE frame, students will write one paragraph discussing how Sun-Sun changes, including a point, at least one piece of evidence from the novel and an explanation.

Learning Domains

- **Cognitive:** Define the five plot stages; classify events; discuss character change with evidence.
- **Affective:** Value each group member's reasons; respond respectfully to a partner's writing.
- **Psychomotor:** Sort event strips onto Freytag's Pyramid; write a PEE paragraph.

Learning Styles

- **Visual:** Freytag's Pyramid on the whiteboard and PowerPoint; PEE frame.
- **Auditory:** Discussion of a familiar story, teacher retelling of Chapters 9–11, group discussion.
- **Kinaesthetic:** Sorting event strips; writing the paragraph.

Resources

- Freytag's Pyramid drawn on the whiteboard with its five labels covered (in Engage below)
- KWL charts (in Engage below)
- Envelopes of printed event strips, Freytag's Pyramid sheet and group role slips (in Explore below)
- Class copies of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson (Chapter 11, pp. 105–107, in Explain below)
- PEE paragraph frame and model paragraph (in Elaborate below)
- Exit tickets and traffic-light slips (in Evaluate below)
- PowerPoint and whiteboard

NSC Major Objectives (Curriculum Alignment)

- Identify the elements of plot structure in a range of narrative pieces. *(Communication (Writing) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: Freytag's Pyramid sort and Exit Ticket Q1–2 (plot stages and order of events).*
- Compose a summary of a text, using main ideas identified. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 2). Checked by: Freytag's Pyramid sheet (one-line summary for each stage).*
- Determine a central idea of a text and analyse its development over the course of the text, including its relationship to supporting ideas. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 1). Checked by: PEE paragraph and Exit Ticket Q3 (how Sun-Sun changes, with evidence).*

Instructional Strategies

- **KWL Chart:** Engage – what students know and want to know about how a whole story is built.
- **Graphic Organizer (Freytag's Pyramid):** Engage to Explain – the five-part shape of a plot.
- **Cooperative Card Sort with Role Slips:** Explore – groups place events on Freytag's Pyramid.
- **Teacher Retelling and Read-Aloud:** Explain – Chapters 9–11 and the fire scene.
- **Higher-Order Questioning:** Explain – analyse, compare, evaluate and create questions.
- **Modelled Writing (PEE):** Elaborate – the teacher writes a model paragraph before students write.
- **Differentiated Instruction:** Elaborate – sentence-starter frame and extension question.
- **Peer Assessment (Star and Wish):** Elaborate – partners check each other's PEE paragraph.
- **Traffic-Light Self-Assessment and Exit Ticket:** Evaluate – individual check on plot stages.

Subject Integration

- **Social Studies (Explain):** Students discuss how the villagers treat Sun-Sun when he is poor and when he is successful, and what this shows about social class and status in a community.
- **Mathematics (Elaborate):** Students work out how much of the £7,000 loan Sun-Sun had paid back when he still owed £4,300 (Chapter 1), and how many years pass between Rami at 15 and Rami at 17.

Classroom Organization and Management

- **Classroom layout and safety:** Desks are arranged in groups of four facing the whiteboard for the card sort, then turned forward for writing. Bags hang on the backs of chairs and walkways are kept clear so the teacher can reach every group.
- **Materials:** Cards, strips and worksheets are prepared in labelled envelopes before the lesson, so no time is lost handing them out.
- **Group roles:** For group tasks, each member receives a role slip (see the slips in the procedure) so every student knows exactly what to do and no one is left out.
- **Transitions:** The teacher uses the call-and-response "Class, class!" / "Yes, yes!" as an attention signal, and a visible timer shows how long each phase lasts.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Specific verbal praise, group points on the board, and good work displayed on the word wall.
- **Expectations:** Listen when others speak, respect every answer, share tasks fairly, and handle materials carefully.

Accommodations (Inclusion)

- **Reading difficulties:** Large-print cards and a reading partner; the teacher reads text aloud on request.

- **Writing difficulties:** Students may answer orally, point to the correct card, or have a peer scribe one answer.
- **Attention or vision needs:** Preferential seating near the board and the teacher.
- **Absent students:** Students who miss the lesson (for example, for sports) receive the notes and classwork as a catch-up pack.

Backup Plan (No Technology)

- **If there is no electricity, internet or projector:** Freytag's Pyramid and the PEE frame are drawn on the whiteboard or chart paper; event strips, the frame and the model paragraph are printed.

5E PROCEDURE

1. ENGAGEMENT (10 minutes)

- **Activating Prior Knowledge:** The teacher asks: "What is the main conflict between Sun-Sun and Jake? What has happened to Sun-Sun since Chapter 1?" Students fill in the K and W columns of their KWL chart on the plot of the whole novel.

KWL Chart: The Plot of the Whole Novel (one per student)

K – What I Know	W – What I Want to Know	L – What I Learned
e.g. Jake took Robin Hill; Ma married Jake.	*e.g. How does the story end?*	*(Completed in Evaluate)*

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will look at a pyramid drawn on the whiteboard with its five labels covered. The teacher explains that Gustav Freytag, a German writer, showed that most stories follow this shape. Using a story they all know (for example, an Anansi story or a film they have seen), students suggest what happens at the bottom left, at the top and at the bottom right, and the teacher uncovers the labels one by one: exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution.

Freytag's Pyramid (draw on the whiteboard)

1. Exposition	2. Rising action	3. Climax (the top)	4. Falling action	5. Resolution
Characters, setting and problem introduced	Complications build tension (going up)	Turning point; greatest tension	Events after the climax (going down)	The conflict is settled

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will draw the pyramid with the labels covered, guide the discussion, and uncover each label as students reach it. The teacher will ask:
- Where on the pyramid is a story most exciting? Why is that at the top?

- Why does the line go up slowly but come down quickly?
- In the story we chose, what was the climax?
- **Technology (in class):** A blank Freytag's Pyramid is shown on a PowerPoint slide and stays up for the lesson.
- **Formative Check:** Students give a thumbs up or down: "The most exciting part of a story usually comes at the very beginning." (Thumbs down.)

(Visual & Auditory)

2. EXPLORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will work in groups of four. They open the envelope of event strips, read each event aloud, agree on its plot stage, and place it on Freytag's Pyramid sheet. Events from chapters they have not yet read are placed by reasoning and checked in Explain.

Event Strips (print and cut; one set per group)

Event	Chapter
Jake takes Robin Hill for an unpaid debt, and Rami chooses to go with Father to River Bottom.	Ch 1
Mrs Hilcher and Donna Rae welcome them with a corn pone pudding.	Ch 3
Sun-Sun stops giving the villagers credit.	Ch 4
Ma turns up at the market with Jake and threatens to take Rami to court.	Ch 5
Ma marries Jake.	Ch 6
Ma wins custody in court, but Rami refuses to leave his father.	Ch 8
Sun-Sun builds a shop at River Bottom and beats Jake's prices.	Ch 9
At Christmas, Sun-Sun faces Jake in the bar as an equal.	Ch 10
Robin Hill burns. Sun-Sun saves Ma, the baby, Arlene and Brad, goes back for Jake, and dies.	Ch 11
Jake accuses Sun-Sun of starting the fire, and Ma leaves Jake.	Ch 11
Rami buries his father at River Bottom and takes over the store, with Donna Rae beside him.	Ch 11

Freytag's Pyramid Sheet (one per group)

Plot stage	Chapters	Events (write or stick the strips here)
Exposition	1–2	
Rising action	3–10	
Climax	11	
Falling action	11	
Resolution	11	

Group Role Slips (cut out; give one slip to each group member)

✂️ **Reader**
Read each event strip aloud to the group.

✂️ **Arranger**
Place each strip on Freytag's Pyramid once the group agrees.

✂️ **Checker**
Check the chapter number on each strip and make sure the order is correct.

✂️ **Reporter**
Share one placement and the group's reason with the class.

Teacher Answers: Freytag's Pyramid

Exposition: Jake takes Robin Hill; Rami goes with Father to River Bottom (Ch 1).

Rising action: the Hilchers' welcome (Ch 3); no more credit (Ch 4); Ma at the market with Jake (Ch 5); Ma marries Jake (Ch 6); the custody case (Ch 8); the shop beats Jake's prices (Ch 9); Sun-Sun faces Jake at Christmas (Ch 10).

Climax: Robin Hill burns; Sun-Sun saves the family, goes back for Jake and dies (Ch 11).

Falling action: Jake accuses Sun-Sun of starting the fire; Ma leaves Jake (Ch 11).

Resolution: Rami buries his father at River Bottom and takes over the store, with Donna Rae beside him (Ch 11).

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the envelopes and role slips, circulate, and ask groups to give a reason for each placement.
- **Formative Check:** Each Reporter shares one placement and the reason; the class agrees or corrects it.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "Good – you placed the court case in rising action because it makes things harder for Sun-Sun. Now find the one event where the tension is highest."

(Kinaesthetic & Auditory)

3. EXPLANATION (12 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will copy the five plot-stage definitions, listen as the teacher retells Chapters 9–11 and reads the fire scene aloud, and correct their group's copy of Freytag's Pyramid.

Key Definitions (students copy into notebooks)

Exposition: the beginning, where characters, setting and the problem are introduced.

Rising action: events and complications that build tension.

Climax: the turning point; the moment of greatest tension.

Falling action: events just after the climax, as things settle.

Resolution: the ending, where the conflict is settled.

Types of conflict: man vs. man (Sun-Sun vs. Jake); man vs. society (village gossip and class prejudice); man vs. self (Sun-Sun's carelessness with money).

Read-Aloud: The Fire at Robin Hill (Chapter 11, pp. 105–107)

Teacher reads aloud from the class copy, from Sun-Sun arriving at the burning house to Ma's words after the fire. The novel is under copyright, so the passage is not reproduced here.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will write the definitions on the whiteboard, retell Chapters 9–11 briefly, read the fire scene aloud, and lead the questions below.
- **Subject Integration (Social Studies):** The teacher asks how the villagers treat Sun-Sun when he is poor (Chapter 1) and when he is successful (Chapter 10), and what this shows about social class and status.

Higher-Order Questions (whole-class discussion)

1. Analyse: Why is the fire the climax and not the court case?
2. Compare: How is Sun-Sun at the start of the novel different from Sun-Sun at the end?
3. Evaluate: Was Sun-Sun right to go back into the fire for Jake? Give a reason.
4. Create: Write a different resolution, and explain how it would change the message of the novel.

Guide answers: the fire is the point of greatest tension and changes everything, while the court case only makes things harder; careless and too generous at the start, shrewd and selfless at the end; accept either view with a reason; accept any logical ending with a link to theme.

- **Technology (in class):** The definitions and the completed Freytag's Pyramid are shown on a PowerPoint slide.
- **Formative Check:** The teacher names three events; students say the plot stage chorally.

(Visual & Auditory)

4. ELABORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will study the teacher's model PEE paragraph, then write their own PEE paragraph answering the question in the box below. They keep this paragraph: it becomes part of their essay in Week 11.

How to Write a PEE Paragraph

P – Point: one sentence that answers the question.

E – Evidence: an event or a short quotation from the novel, with the chapter.

E – Explain: say how the evidence proves your point. Use "This shows…" or "This suggests…".

Teacher Model (on a different question): How is Rami loyal?

Rami is loyal to his father. In Chapter 1, when Father loses Robin Hill, Rami chooses the cabin at River Bottom over the comfort of his mother's house, saying, "I'm going with you." This shows that Rami cares more about standing by his father than about money or comfort.

Student Task (write in your notebook)

Discuss how Sun-Sun changes from the beginning to the end of the novel.

Sentence starters: At the start of the novel, Sun-Sun is… For example, in Chapter… This shows… By the end, Sun-Sun… This suggests…

Teacher Answers: Sample Paragraph

At the start of the novel, Sun-Sun is careless and too generous with money. He loses Robin Hill to Jake because of debt and gambling, and in Chapter 4 he lets villagers take food on credit. However, he changes when he decides that "To be good among them is to be a fool," stops giving credit, and builds a shop that beats Jake's prices. By the end he is selfless: he dies saving Jake from the fire. This shows that Sun-Sun grows from a careless man into a shrewd and heroic one.

- **Differentiation Support:** Supported students use the sentence-starter frame and may use the event strips as evidence.
- **Differentiation Extension:** Extended students add a second piece of evidence and a sentence on what Sun-Sun's change teaches the reader.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will write the model paragraph on the whiteboard, label P, E and E, then circulate and conference with students as they write.
- **Subject Integration (Mathematics):** Students work out how much of the £7,000 loan Sun-Sun had paid back when he still owed £4,300, and how many years pass from Rami at 15 to Rami at 17.
- **Numeracy Link:** £7,000 – £4,300 = £2,700 paid back; 17 – 15 = 2 years.

- **Peer Assessment:** Partners swap paragraphs and mark P, E and E in pen (write the letter beside each part), then give one star and one wish.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "Your point is clear. Now add the chapter so your evidence can be checked."

(Visual & Kinaesthetic)

5. EVALUATION (8 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the exit ticket on their own, then fill in the L column of the KWL chart and the traffic-light self-assessment.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will collect the exit tickets and make sure students keep their PEE paragraphs in their notebooks for Week 11.

Exit Ticket

1. Name the plot stage where Robin Hill burns.
2. Put these in order: Ma marries Jake; Rami buries his father at River Bottom; Jake takes Robin Hill.
3. Write one piece of evidence that shows Sun-Sun changes.

Teacher Answers: Exit Ticket

1. The climax. 2. Jake takes Robin Hill → Ma marries Jake → Rami buries his father at River Bottom. 3. e.g. he stops giving credit (Ch 4); he builds a shop and beats Jake's prices (Ch 9); he goes back into the fire to save Jake (Ch 11).

- **Self-Assessment:** Students tick one box for each statement.

Traffic-Light Self-Assessment (students tick one colour for each statement)

I can…	Green	Yellow	Red
name the five stages of plot	☐	☐	☐
put the main events of the novel in order	☐	☐	☐
write a PEE paragraph with evidence	☐	☐	☐

Green = I can do this on my own. Yellow = I need a little more practice. Red = I need help.

- **Closure:** One student completes the sentence aloud: "The climax of the novel is… because…"
- **Positive Reinforcement:** The teacher praises groups that gave clear reasons and students whose paragraphs had all three parts, and awards class points.

(Visual & Auditory)

Total: 10 + 15 + 12 + 15 + 8 = 60 minutes

Homework / Extension Assignment

Task: Rewrite your PEE paragraph neatly, using your partner's wish to improve it. Add one more piece of evidence from the novel. Bring it to the next lesson: it becomes part of your essay.

Grading Criteria (10 marks)

Criteria	What is expected	Marks
Point	A clear sentence that answers the question	2
Evidence	At least two pieces of evidence from the novel, with chapters	3
Explain	Explains how the evidence shows Sun-Sun changes	3
Writing	Complete sentences in Standard Jamaican English, with correct capital letters and full stops	2
Total		**10**

Technology Integration (Homework & Practice)

- **Google Classroom:** Post Freytag's Pyramid answers and the PEE frame. Students may type and submit their paragraph.
- **Quizizz:** Assign an optional practice quiz on the five plot stages and the main events of Chapters 1–11.

Assessment Summary

Type	What is assessed
Diagnostic	KWL chart (K and W); Freytag's Pyramid discussion of a familiar story.
Formative	Freytag's Pyramid sort with Reporter feedback; choral check; PEE paragraph with peer feedback.
Summative	Exit ticket; PEE paragraph homework (10 marks).

Success Criteria

Students are successful when they can name the five plot stages, place the main events of the novel under the correct stage, and write a PEE paragraph showing how Sun-Sun changes.

Link to Previous and Next Lesson

- **Previous:** Week 9 – Imagery and theme in "My Parents".
- **Next:** Week 11 – Essay writing: building the four-paragraph comparison essay.

APA References

- Ministry of Education, Youth and Information. (2018). *National Standards Curriculum: Language and Literature Grades 7–9*. Kingston, Jamaica: MoEYI.
- Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information. (n.d.). *Curriculum analysis: Essential objectives & content focus – NSC Grades 7–9* (2nd ed.). Kingston, Jamaica.

- Palmer, C. E. (1974). *My father, Sun-Sun Johnson*. Macmillan Caribbean.

Lesson Evaluation (complete after teaching)

What went well:

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What to improve:

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Students who need follow-up:

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